INDIA TODAY S2
STATE OF THE STATES
TAMIL NADU FIRST

(from left) **Zubin Songadwala,** *Area Manager, Southern Region, ITC Hotels;* **V. Sriram,** *Historian and Heritage Activist, Chennai;* **Dr. B. Chandra Mohan,** *IAS, Principal Secretary to Government, Tourism, Culture and Religious Endowments and Chairman, Tamil Nadu Tourism Development Corporation*



▶ MAKING TAMIL NADU THE TOURIST DESTINATION OF THE SOUTH

TAKEAWAYS

1. Launch initiatives so that Tamil Nadu remains No.1 in drawing both domestic and international tourists.
2. Unveil an exclusive Tamil Nadu Tourism policy that accords industry status to the hospitality business.
3. Expand the temple tourism network now that many among the 44,000 odd temples in the state have a website of their own.
4. Develop specific sites as adventure tourism hubs.
5. Promote plantation tourism with tea estate owners showing willingness to come on board.



(from left) **V. Thiruppugazh,** *IAS (Retd), Chairman, Advisory Committee on Mitigation and Management of Flood Risk in Chennai Metro and Disaster Management Expert;* **Jayaram Venkatesan,** *Convener, Arappor Iyakkam, Chennai;* **Nityanand Jayaraman,** *Environmental activist, Chennai;* **Mridula Ramesh,** *Cleantech Investor and Founder, Sundaram Climate Institute*

▲ MAKING CHENNAI THE FUTURE CITY

TAKEAWAYS

1. Improving risk governance by investing in risk reduction; stopping accumulation of risks; creating storage capacity in the upstream and staggering a run-off for mitigating and managing flood risks.
2. Perceive solid waste as a Brahmastra on our back and treat it as a resource that can create thousands of jobs.
3. Consider Chennai's expansion and growth, from 47 sq km in 1980 to 402 sq km, as a double-edged sword and disaster.
4. Treat never-ending growth as something that exacts a price from certain neighbourhoods and communities, like the petroleum refinery and major ports coming up on marshland and island of Katrapalli.